Seizure of Cocaine concealed in baggage at Mumbai

CASE STUDY - 05

Name of the Drug : Cocaine

Qty. Seized : 5 Kg Cocaine

NCB Zonal Unit : Mumbai Zonal Unit

Total Arrest : 02 Persons

Intelligence and interception

- Pursuant to active intelligence follow-up concerning international drug trafficking, a Bolivian woman was identified as having arrived from Sao Paolo to Mumbai via Dubai by Etihad Airlines on 12.10.2023 with a drug consignment and was staying at a pre-booked hotel in Khetwadi, Mumbai.

Seizure

- After the team confirmed the woman's presence, she was intercepted with another Bolivian national. Search of their belongings resulted in recovery of a total of 05 kg of Cocaine from the baggage of both women.

Concealment and investigation

- The drugs were concealed among ordinary items including undergarments, clothes, toothpaste, cosmetic tubes, soap, footwear and a makeup kit, in powder, liquid and paste forms. During interrogation, the women provided information about their handler and stated that they had crossed over to Brazil to receive the consignment before travelling onward to Mumbai.

ORIGINAL SOURCE VISUAL

Original NCB Annual Report 2023 page containing Case Study 05, reproduced from the uploaded source.

CASE STUDY-05

Name of the Drug : Cocaine **Qty. Seized : 5 Kg Cocaine**

NCB Zonal Unit : Mumbai Zonal Unit **Total Arrest: 02 Persons**

- In pursuance of active intelligence follow up pertaining to international drug trafficking, based on specific input, a Bolivian lady 'X' was identified to have arrived from Sao Paolo to Mumbai via Dubai by Etihad airlines on 12.10.2023 along with drug consignment and was staying at a pre-booked hotel in Khetwadi, Mumbai. Immediately, a team was constituted which proceeded to the hotel and setup a discreet search operation.
- Upon confirmation about presence of the lady, the team intercepted her who was with another lady 'Y' a Bolivian national. Upon preliminary questioning, no satisfactory reply was given by the duo upon which search of their belongings was made during which total 05 Kgs Cocaine was recovered from baggage of both ladies.
- The drugs were guilefully concealed among non-suspicious items as undergarments, cloths, toothpaste, cosmetic tubes, soap, footwear, makeup kit. The drugs were carefully concealed in form of powder, liquid & paste which could be easily planted among regular items.
- During interrogation, they revealed information about their handler and stated that in order to minimise suspicion of anti drug agencies, they opted to travel from Dubai to Mumbai by Etihad Airways. They revealed that they crossed over to Brazil and received the consignment and parted ways for the travel. In evasive maneuver, they boarded flights from different cities in Brazil. Both arrived in Mumbai and were changing their locations frequently. When NCB team intercepted them, them were in preparing to check out of the hotel.



